

Peace and Security at a Crossroads: the 2026 European Student Young Pugwash Conference



As Europe confronts a rapidly deteriorating security landscape, debates over the future of European security, strategic autonomy, and evolving risks are becoming increasingly urgent. In this context, the Student Young Pugwash (SYP) network aims to foster an informed, forward-looking, and policy-relevant dialogue on the contemporary security challenges that will shape Europe's future, placing the next generation of European decision-makers at the centre of the conversation.

A pan-European Organising Committee was established in spring 2026 to organise the inaugural European SYP Conference (EuSYPC), to be held in Pisa, Italy, from 25–27 September 2026. Composed of 15–20 young professionals, the Committee includes members of UNIPi, USPID, SYP Italy, SYP UK, SYP Germany, SYP France, SYP Spain, and International SYP, embodying a collaborative effort across the leading European branches of the SYP network.

Building on the legacy of the Nobel Peace Prize-winning Pugwash Conferences on Science and World Affairs, the Conference will bring together leading practitioners, scholars, and young professionals working at the intersection of science and policy for a timely discussion on the evolving relationship between security, deterrence, and non-proliferation in Europe.

Through a competitive call for applications, the EuSYPC will convene 35–45 outstanding young professionals from across Europe, providing them with a platform to contribute innovative and forward-looking perspectives on peace, security, and non-proliferation. In doing so, the Conference seeks to support the next generation of scientists, scholars, and practitioners through capacity-building, professional networking, and sustained cross-border collaboration, while also fostering a stronger sense of European cohesion and shared responsibility in addressing common security challenges.

The EuSYPC will be held in collaboration with the Unione Scienziati per il Disarmo (USPID), the University of Pisa Department of Physics (DIFI), and the Centro Interdisciplinare Scienze per la Pace (CISP).

